

to produce 2MW per day. An approximate capital of 100 million rupees was invested to set up the power plant infrastructure. For almost 8000 units of solar power produced per day, 'Celebi' now saves 64,000 rupees per day—as against tariffs paid to **DISCOM at the rate of 8 rupees per unit**. The project's expected ROI time is five-and-a-half years. The project has been operational for almost two years now.

Selling to private companies. A private solar power generating company is free to sell power to other private companies through a power purchase agreement.

Captive consumption. If the power generated by one unit of a business conglomerate is utilised by the same and other units of the business, it is defined as captive consumption. A classic case is that of Tata Steel, which utilises the power generated by Tata Solar.

Karan Sharma, managing director, SunSmith Infra, shares, "We have installed a 200kW rooftop solar plant at OM Furnishers in Gujarat. The initial capital investment required to set up the plant was 9.6 million rupees. The plant will produce about 1000 units of electricity per day, thereby saving 7000 rupees on a daily basis which would otherwise would have been paid to Dakshin Gujarat Bijli Vidyut Nigam Ltd as tariff."

"It has become challenging to pin down an installation number as so many projects that are completed are stranded and unable to commission due to evacuation delays. It will all depend on what can get connected to the grid by the end of the year," said Priya Sanjay, managing director of Mercem India.

Government adaptation

Presently, Solar Energy Corporation of India undertakes solar rooftop power generation under two models:

CAPEX. Within this model, the complete rooftop system is owned by the private entity (third party). Lifetime (25 years) operations and maintenance is also within the purview of the third-party rooftop owner. Developers are responsible only for the first two years. They are selected through an extensive bidding process and are offered 30 per cent subsidy on the cost of the total system.

RESCO. In this model the entire system is owned by the developer. Operations and maintenance also remain the developer's responsibility. Rooftop owners can consume electricity on the basis of a pre-decided tariff. Excessive power is transferred to the grid, based on the local government's rules and regulations. For this model as well, the developers are selected through a bidding process.

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